Hound

THE HOUND GUIDE

Everything you can do in Hound

Hound turns the steps, walks and workouts your phone already counts into games with your friends and a hound that lives the day with you. Here's all of it, and where to find each thing in the app.

Get started

1. **Get the app**

   iPhone: join the beta in TestFlight. Android: download it from **houndchallenge.net/get**.

2. **Connect your health data**

   Hound reads steps, distance and workouts from Apple Health or Health Connect, so anything your phone or watch counts, counts.

   `You → Health data`

3. **Set your goals and meet your hound**

   Everyone starts with 10,000 steps a day, 3 miles a day and 3 workouts a week. Make them yours, then name your hound.

   `Today → Set your goals`

4. **Start or join a challenge**

   Pick a game, set the dates and invite friends, or join a Global Hound Challenge from Today.

   `Challenges → New challenge`

5. **Turn on notifications**

   So you hear about invites, your Tic-Tac-Go turn, nudges and the end of a challenge.

   `You → Settings → Notifications`

Challenges

15 kinds, all played on the steps, miles and workouts you'd do anyway. Some unlock once you've earned enough Bones; the lock shows how many.

RACES AND TARGETS

Step Race

Most steps during the challenge. Everyone against everyone.

Any group · Bones pot optional

Group Distance Target

Every mile the group covers adds up toward one shared target.

A team effort

Daily Streak

Hit a daily goal every day. One miss and you're out.

Last one standing

Chase

One runner gets a head start. The other has to catch them on logged miles before time runs out.

Hunter and hunted

Game of Tag

One person is "IT" and has to catch someone before time runs out. No ranking: just don't get caught.

Any group

Journey

Everyone walks the same famous course from the same start. Walks, runs and hikes move you along the map, with stops and postcards on the way. First to the end wins.

Golden Gate Bridge 1.7 mi · Windy City, Five Boroughs and Thames 26.2 · Death Valley 135 · Appalachian Trail 2,190 · Route 66 2,448

GAMES

Tic-Tac-Go

Two players, one board. Hit a square's goal to claim it, then it's their move. Three in a row wins.

2 players · Bones pot optional

Bingo

A card of steps, workouts and goals. First to finish a row, column or diagonal wins, and play goes on for the full card.

Any group

Hound'opoly

A property board game on your steps. Each day's steps pick your dice, the roll happens overnight, and you buy the parks and trails you land on. Richest at the end wins.

Any group

Rally

Badminton on your steps. Walk the shuttle's step target before its deadline to send it back a little bigger. Miss and they score. Games to 21, best of three.

One on one

Soccer

A match on everyone's steps, a day at a time. Forwards shoot, defenders block, the keeper saves. Most goals after the last day wins.

Teams of 1 to 9 · friends or bots

Cricket

Limited overs, one over a day. Each ball is the batter's steps against the bowler's: out-walk them for boundaries, fall behind and wickets fall.

Teams of 1 to 9 · friends or bots

Baseball

One inning a day. Each at-bat is your steps against the pitcher's, then the fielder's, then the catcher's at home plate. Aim left, center or right; the catcher calls a shift; big step days clear the fence.

Teams of 1 to 9 · friends or bots · 3 to 9 innings

HABITS

75 Day Challenge

A daily checklist: two workouts (one outdoors), a diet, water, reading and a progress photo. Miss a day and your streak resets, but you keep going.

75 days

Accountability

Your daily checklist, kept with friends: a workout, your steps, a quiet minute, and a line of your own. Tick everything or the day doesn't count.

Any group

WAYS TO PLAY

Global Hound Challenges

Open to everyone on Hound: join from Today while it's open, no invite needed. Some have Bones prizes for the top 3, and some are sponsored.

`Today → Global Hound Challenges`

Community challenges

Publish a challenge that anyone with its code, link or QR code can join. Members from Tracker (level 5) with a username can publish.

`Challenges → Join → Have a code?`

Bones pots

Put 10, 25, 50 or 100 Bones each on a Step Race or Tic-Tac-Go. Winner takes all; a tie splits it. Only Bones earned by playing can go in.

`New challenge → Step Race or Tic-Tac-Go → Pot`

Boards, talk and rematches

- Each challenge has its Board (standings, with ▲▼ for who moved since yesterday), a Talk wall for trash talk, and Details.
- Pin one to the top of Today.
- When it ends: Rematch with the same friends and rules, or Share result with an invite link.

`Tap a challenge → Board · Talk · Details`

Goals and water

Goals

Steps, distance, workouts or workout minutes, every day or every week. Hound suggests a target a little above your last four weeks.

`You → Goals`

The Hound reminds you

Choose how hard Hound hounds you: Gentle (one evening reminder), Persistent (up to 3 a day), Relentless (up to 5) or Off. Reminders stop once your goals are done.

`You → Goals`

Goal streak and Streak Shields

Every goal day pays Bones, and every 7th day in a row pays more. A Streak Shield covers one missed day. Finish every weekly goal for a weekly bonus.

`Today → Goals`

Water

A daily goal in cups or millilitres, a glass at a time, plus water other apps put in Health. Optional sip reminders, and your hound's bowl fills through the day.

`Today → Goals → the blue +`

Your numbers

- Week in review, Monday to Wednesday: last week's steps, challenges, Hound Score and Bones.
- Today's step rank, the rest of the week.
- Personal records: best step day, longest 10k streak, longest workout, farthest day.
- Home screen widgets (from 0.11.0): your hound and today's goals, and steps on the iPhone Lock Screen.

`Today · You → Your data`

Your hound

A hound who lives the day with you, in its own yard.

Mood and care

Its mood follows your goal days over the last week. Give a treat once a day. Gentle care is the default; Classic pet adds meal hearts to keep filled.

`Today → your hound · or You → Kennel`

Its look and wardrobe

- Coat, ears, tail, markings and breeds like Poodle and French Bulldog.
- Collars, bandanas, hats and glasses; sweaters, a hoodie, a raincoat, a tutu, a superhero cape, a tuxedo; booties and sneakers.
- Holiday drops for a little while each season (Thanksgiving, Winter from 15 November). Anything you get, you keep.
- Tap anything to try it on in place: red ✕ puts it back, green ✓ keeps it.

`Kennel → Wardrobe · Look`

The Yard

It grows with your rank. Your hound strolls, naps in bed or the hammock, and drinks from a bowl that fills with your water. Swipe the grass to throw its toy. Trophies you win in challenges stand in it.

`Kennel → Yard`

Houses

From the Hound House to an Igloo (300 Bones), Beach Bungalow (800), Modern Glass House (900), Treehouse (1,000), Castle (1,500) and the Doghouse Mansion (2,500).

`Kennel → Yard → House`

The Porch

Round the back of the house, from Hunter (level 10): a Hot Tub, Lounge Chair, Porch Swing, Fire Pit, Patio Umbrella and Grill.

`Kennel → swipe the sky across, or Yard → Porch`

Tricks

High Five, Spin, Roll Over and Play Dead. Double-tap your hound to see one; friends can do it in your yard too.

`Kennel → More → Tricks`

Fitness, traits, age and a birthday

- Fitness 1 to 10 from active days (5,000 steps). It only goes up, and a fitter hound is livelier.
- Nine traits from your habits, kept for good: Early bird, Night owl, Lunch stroller, Trail dog, Well watered, Weekend warrior, Steady paws, Collector, Green paws.
- A new hound starts as a puppy and grows up with your steps.
- Pick its birthday. On the day, the yard has a party and a friend's hound comes round.

`Kennel → Walks → About`

Your hound as your avatar

It replaces your initials on leaderboards, friends and chats.

`Kennel → Use as my avatar`

Walks and the garden

Your walks become your hound's walks, with nothing to start or stop.

Walk recaps

Ten minutes or more of steady steps is a walk: "Morning walk · 8:06 AM · 1.5 mi · 32 min".

`Kennel → Walks`

Walk finds and the collection book

Every finished walk brings something home, up to 5 a day. 22 kinds: a good stick, a feather, an old tennis ball… and seasonal ones like a golden acorn or a perfect snowflake. Longer walks find rarer things.

`Kennel → Walks → Open the collection book`

Your hound's diary

A line a day in its own voice, from your walks, finds, steps and water: "A long evening walk: 3.7 mi. My paws are tired." Only you see it, unless you share the week.

`Kennel → Walks → Diary`

The garden

Three plots in the Yard. Plant a seed and your steps water it: a daisy blooms at 20,000 steps, a giant sunflower at 70,000. A day off pauses it; nothing wilts. One free seed a week, and seed packs for Bones.

`Kennel → Yard → Garden`

Rewards

Hound Score, XP and ranks

Hound Score grows with your results and never goes down. XP from playing, opening Hound and your goals fills your level. Ranks: Pup, Tracker (level 5), Hunter (10), Alpha (15), Legend (20).

`You`

Bones

- Earned from every finished challenge, levelling up, the daily bonus, goal days, Bone Dig and achievements.
- Get a Bones pack, or, when it's on, watch a short ad for a few more.
- Spent on your hound, its yard and garden, your look, Streak Shields, treats and bounties.

`The Bones pill at the top of the Kennel`

Daily bonus and Bone Dig

Open Hound each day for a bonus, bigger on every 7th day in a row. Finish your daily goals and dig once for Bones or a piece toward Dig items you can't buy.

`Today`

Achievements

One-time badges that each pay Bones: first finish and first win, a Bingo blackout, a perfect Daily Streak, big step days and weeks, water days, levels.

`You → Achievements`

Your look

Avatar frames, backgrounds and icons, unlocked by level or bought with Bones.

`You → Your look`

Friends

Add friends

Search by name, pick from People you may know, share your code or QR code, enter or scan theirs, invite by email, or tap Add next to anyone on a leaderboard.

`Friends tab`

Cheer each other on

- Friend activity: friends' wins and achievements, with kudos.
- Head-to-head: your record against a friend.
- Nudges, once a day, and trash talk on each challenge's wall.

`Friends tab → a friend`

Bounties

Put Bones on a step target. The first friend to reach it today takes them; nobody by midnight and they come back to you.

`Today → Bounties → Post one`

Visits and gifts

Visit a friend's yard (your hound comes too), leave a pawprint or a treat, and send their hound a gift with a note.

`A friend's page`

Settings

Make it yours

- Light mode, and a larger text size.
- A username to show instead of your name in challenges.
- Choose whether you show up in Find people.
- Pick exactly which notifications you get.

`You → Settings`

Organizations

For schools and companies using Hound together, with their own words for things (and for Bones).

`You → Settings`

Help in the app

A searchable how-to for every challenge type and feature.

`Top bar → ?`

Found a bug or have an idea? Send it our way. Screenshots help a lot. Thanks for testing Hound! Updated 3 November 2026.